

0 to \$5,000/mo in her first 30 days ever

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Executive Summary

Amy, a 27-year-old Washington-state tech worker with zero prior Etsy experience, earned ~\$4,950 USD in her first month selling clothing on Etsy after joining the Easy Etsy coaching program — working just 30 minutes to a couple of hours per day.

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Meet Amy: Background & Personality 0:45

- Age 27, born and raised in Washington state, USA
- Currently works full-time in tech (design-adjacent role)
- Also works as an adjunct professor at a university on the side
- Describes herself as very busy with many hobbies:
 - Knitting, gardening, keeping chickens, cats, and dogs
- Entrepreneurial from childhood:
 - Always trying to start small businesses or invent new things
 - Self-described "art kid" with a creative background
 - Motivational story: her dad (softball coach) offered her **\$5 per time she reached first base** — she started hitting well and would earn ~\$15 per game
 - "It's part of what informed what I did career-wise"

- Musician and artist by background, pursued tech for stability while staying close to design
- Has a 5-year relationship with her partner (anniversary on the 9th)

Career Path & Motivation to Diversify Income 1:57

- Chose tech/design as a stable career path while keeping creative work alive
- Cites the AI-driven wave of tech layoffs as a major wake-up call:
 - "What previously was such a surefire way to make an income is becoming much less so"
- **Key catalyst:** In November, she was laid off from a company she'd worked at for **4 years**
 - Described it as "felt like a breakup" — loved the product, loved the team, felt like an identity crisis
 - Secured a good contract role afterward, but the experience hardened her resolve to diversify
- Had already been researching income diversification:
 - Attended "tons" of sales calls for various online money-making programs
 - Had done a B2B sales internship where she out-hit-quota all the business school interns despite being a design major — loved the human connection aspect
- Looked into short-term rentals / real estate but concluded:
 - Capital requirements too high
 - ROI math didn't beat simply investing in ETFs passively
 - Led her to look for low-barrier-to-entry alternatives

Why She Chose E-Commerce Over Other Online Models 5:05

- Compared options: trading, SMMA, appointment setting, short-term rentals
- Chose e-commerce primarily for **low barrier to entry and low upfront cost**
 - "Since it's not really costing me pretty much anything other than the course up front — why not try it?"
- The Easy Etsy program's money-back guarantee reduced perceived risk
 - Was still skeptical: "I'll give it a try — even then I was like, there's no way"
 - Appreciated that the salesperson (Tien) genuinely tried to determine if it was a good fit for her rather than just closing her
 - High reported student success rate combined with the guarantee made it feel safe

Getting Started: First Store & First Sale 7:47

- Went through the course modules first — found them "very thorough"
- Set up her first store without telling her partner:
 - Reasoning: "This probably isn't going to work, so I don't want to make it a whole thing yet"
- **First listing date: approximately April 8th**
- **First sale: within 3 days of listing**

- Reaction: "Hang on" — then kept getting more sales
- Found an unexpected advantage: her years of professional design experience crossed over directly into e-commerce
 - Especially in product research, user pain point analysis, and customer empathy mapping
 - "I think it was fun to get to loop that in"

First-Month Results 11:41

- Interview date: May 12th — just over one month from first listing (April 8th)
- **Revenue: ~\$4,950 USD ("\$50 shy of \$5,000")** in first month
 - Equivalent to ~\$7,000 AUD at time of interview
- Has been carefully tracking profits, expenses, and margins
 - Hitting the margin targets taught in the course modules
 - Pricing methodology from the modules was specifically cited as helpful
- Etsy payment reserve not yet lifted, but had already received some deposits
- Time investment: **minimum 30 minutes/day, maximum a couple of hours/day**
 - Still working full-time tech job simultaneously

Why Amy Thinks She Succeeded 15:33

- **Intentional, careful product research** — not just chasing metrics
- Applied a "user journey" framework from her design/UX background:
 - Asks: Why is the customer here? What are their pain points? What are their hopes and desires? What does this product solve or bring to them?
- "People sometimes lose a bit of that true empathy" — keeping empathy is a competitive advantage
- Followed course recommendations while layering in her own professional methodology
- Willingness to follow proven trial-and-error guidance from the program

Product Research Methodology (Step-by-Step) 23:26

- Uses **Chrome extensions for 1688 and AliExpress**
- Step-by-step process:
 - Search a product type on Etsy (e.g., "spring dress")
 - Identify the **best sellers** in that category
 - Search for similar products on **1688**
 - On 1688, check for **high sales volume and good reviews** — treat this as a validation signal
 - Factor in **time of year and upcoming holidays** when choosing products
 - Consider the **primary Etsy demographic** (predominantly older women) when evaluating appeal
 - Ask: "Would a 50-year-old woman feel comfortable and beautiful in this?"

- Step out of your own taste/age/demographic lens entirely
- Metric-checking + customer journey thinking = the full framework
 - Metrics alone are not enough; you need the empathy layer too

The Etsy Customer Lens: Who's Actually Buying 24:11

- Etsy's primary demographic: **older/middle-aged women**
- Key insight from Amy: products that appeal to a broad age range (e.g., modest but attractive clothing) capture multiple customer segments
 - "Modest clothing — regardless of whether somebody is highly modest or not, if it's a nice dress, you have a few different people that can meet in the middle"
- Takumi (the host) reinforced this with his own story:
 - He and his business partner Ben physically visited **shopping malls in Sydney**, observed what middle-aged women were wearing, and noted it down — then applied those observations to their Etsy stores
 - Sold "tummy coverage dresses" — normal-looking dresses framed in descriptions as covering stomach and arms — which performed very well
 - Example angle: "This covers your stomach. This covers your arms."
- Key principle: **look through the customer's lens, not your own**

"There's a market for everything. I'll be brutally honest — sometimes I see a product and think there's no way this sells. And then it sells."

Hurdles & Challenges 17:35

- **Product quality issues** were the biggest hiccup
 - Difficult to evaluate quality when sourcing from overseas (especially pricing differences vs. US/Australia)
 - "You're kind of going in blind" when starting out
 - Received mixed feedback on a specific product: some great reviews, some complaints
 - Found it hard to know how much weight to assign to negative vs. positive feedback
 - Program mentor (Shirley) stepped in at points to advise: "Hey, don't do this one, do a different one"
- **Handling unhappy customers** — emotionally difficult
 - Amy is a people-pleaser: "I'll do anything to make the situation better"
 - Sometimes, even with excellent customer service, you can't turn a negative situation around and "you just have to take the L"
 - Takumi shared his own early experience: negative customer messages significantly affected his emotional state early on
 - His solution: **delegated customer service very early** and detached himself from reading complaint messages directly

- Received summarized feedback from his CS manager instead — "really kept my mental game in check"

Delegation & Scaling 21:02

- Amy has **not yet delegated any tasks** — runs everything herself
 - Describes her store as "my baby" — feels like a control freak about messaging quality
 - Acknowledges she's ready to delegate and knows it would work with proper coaching/flagging systems
- Takumi's delegation philosophy:
 - Hire a **virtual assistant (VA)** for tasks that don't directly generate revenue
 - Focus personal time on **high-ROI tasks** only
 - Delegating customer service was specifically highlighted as freeing up mental and time resources for scaling
 - Note: some people run lean teams solo with 12-hour days — possible, but not his preference

Future Goals & Plans 13:10

- **Short-term revenue goal:** \$10,000/month
- **Longer-term revenue goal:** \$50,000/month
 - "Why have a ceiling?" — open to exceeding any target
- Plans to **expand the number of Etsy stores**
 - Will have more free time opening up soon to accelerate this
 - Exploring additional sub-niches
- Wants to eventually **build her own brand on Shopify**
 - Feels confident in branding and marketing from design background
 - Considering visiting China to meet manufacturers in person once she scales to that point
 - Thinking about clothing based on early Etsy success, but wants to validate via product testing (problem-solving vs. desire-based frameworks)
- Side project: **Finance education Instagram**
 - Passionate about making investing accessible for women and queer people who lack access to that education
 - Goal is to eventually dedicate more time to e-commerce and this passion project simultaneously

Golden Nuggets for Beginners 22:37

- **Do thorough product research** — this is the single most repeated piece of advice
 - Look at metrics, but don't stop there
 - Map the **customer journey**: Why is the customer on Etsy? What pain points do they have? What are their hopes and desires?

- If unfamiliar with customer journey mapping, search "user journey" or "customer journey" online for examples and apply that thinking to product selection
- **Step outside your own perspective** — especially important because Etsy's core buyer is likely different from you
 - Ask: Would the actual target customer want this? Would they feel beautiful/comfortable/seen in this?
- **Follow the proven methodology** from whatever program or resource you're using, especially on pricing and margins
 - Amy specifically credits hitting the margin targets outlined in the modules as key to her profitability
- **Validate before committing** — don't get attached to an idea before testing it in the market
 - Treat product ideas as hypotheses to be validated, not certainties
- **Track everything** — profits, expenses, and margins from day one